

- Pattern 4)— GA 1072 (M Lavras, XIII, eapr) is an all but perfect copy of the line of transmission that has Pattern 4). GA 246 (Moscow, XIV, e) is almost perfect.
- Pattern 5)— GA 18 (Constantinople, 1364, eapr) and GA 2503 (Sinai, XIV, e) are almost perfect copies of the line of transmission that has Pattern 5).
- Pattern 6)— GA 586 (Modena, XIV, e) is a perfect copy of the line of transmission that has Pattern 6). GA 2382 (Constantinople, XII, e) is almost perfect, and GA 510 (Oxford-cc, XII, e) is virtually so.

Clearly the copyists were faithfully reproducing their exemplars, that represented distinct lines of transmission. Three of the patterns have overt XI century attestation, and another has overt XII, and all have scattered geographic distribution. The evidence before us simply requires the conclusion that the Family 35 archetype had to exist in the uncial period, and probably well back in that period. I have argued elsewhere that the evidence in hand indicates that it already existed in the III century, if not earlier still. **All preconceived notions concerning von Soden's K^r need to be discarded.**

Should anyone bother to count the MSS, pro and con, he will discover that the form I have chosen as archetypal has a numerical majority in only two of the five cases. Counting only the MSS included in the seven leading patterns, my choice is ahead in four of the five. Aside from the dominant nature of pattern 1), my choice was dictated by quality of MS and geographic distribution, in each case. But as pointed out at the beginning, the difference in meaning is so slight that a single translation can cover both readings, in every case. **God has preserved His Text!**

The Divine Preservation of the Original Wording of the General Epistles

As a point of departure for this discussion I will use a definition of 'preservation' written by Bart D. Ehrman:

Any claim that God preserved the text of the New Testament intact, giving His church actual, not theoretical, possession of it, must [emphasis added] mean one of three things—either 1) God preserved it in all the extant manuscripts so that none of them contain any textual corruptions, or 2) He preserved it in a group of manuscripts, none of which contain any corruptions, or 3) He